

Monthly JBV / Research Policy Digest

Generated: 2026-06-14 12:39 **Coverage:** 2026-07-01 to Available online 29 May 2026 | Journal of Business Venturing (12); Research Policy (19) **Total papers:** 31 (31 with abstract, 31 with PDF)

Journal breakdown: - Journal of Business Venturing: 12 - Research Policy: 19

Table of Contents

Journal of Business Venturing

- [Volume 41, Issue 5 | Published 2026-09-01](#) (5)
- [Volume 41, Issue 4 | Published 2026-07-01](#) (7)

Research Policy

- [Volume 55, Issue 8 | Published 2026-10-01](#) (14)
 - [Volume 55, Issue 7 | Published 2026-09-01](#) (4)
 - [Volume ?, Issue ? | Published Available online 29 May 2026](#) (1)
-

Journal of Business Venturing

Volume 41, Issue 5 | Published 2026-09-01

1. A romantic penalty? Female entrepreneurship and relationship initiation in online dating

Authors: Di Tong, Xiumei Li, Haemin Dennis Park

DOI: [10.1016/j.jbusvent.2026.106608](https://doi.org/10.1016/j.jbusvent.2026.106608) **Published:** 2026-09-01

Fields & Theories:

- **Fields:** Female Entrepreneurship, Social Psychology, Gender Studies
- **Theories:** Family Embeddedness Perspective, Social Role Theory, Signaling Theory

Abstract:

Female entrepreneurship is increasingly common, yet we know little about how it affects women's romantic prospects, a crucial outcome with implications for family formation. We propose that female entrepreneurs, particularly those pursuing growth-oriented ventures, face diminished romantic prospects, potentially shaped by gendered trait inferences and concerns about time demand. Using two field experiments, supplemented by a survey experiment, we provide causal evidence that female entrepreneurs are on average penalized in romantic relationship initiation, but are preferred by male entrepreneurs. Further analysis offers suggestive evidence on mechanisms underlying this romantic penalty. By examining the impact of female entrepreneurship on romantic prospects, our study extends the family embeddedness perspective in entrepreneurship research. It also contributes to female entrepreneurship research by documenting a romantic penalty as a previously underexplored challenge.

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2. A theoretical analysis of the relationship between entrepreneurial competencies and entrepreneurial actions: A proposed model

Authors: Mark T. Schenkel, Rodney R. D'Souza, Jeffrey S. Hornsby, Donald S. Siegel, Maribel Guerrero

DOI: [10.1016/j.jbusvent.2026.106609](#) **Published:** 2026-09-01

Fields & Theories:

- **Fields:** Entrepreneurship, Organizational Behavior
- **Theories:** Social Cognitive Theory, Human Capital Theory, Identity Theory, Ambidexterity

Abstract:

Entrepreneurship research has long emphasized the importance of competencies. Unfortunately, the nature and role of competencies in the entrepreneurship process is somewhat fragmented and atheoretical. To fill these gaps, we outline a dynamic, integrative, and inclusive theoretical model, which draws on theories of social cognition, ambidexterity, human capital, and identity. Our model explains how metacompetencies shape entrepreneurial self-efficacy, which, in turn, drives specific entrepreneurial behavior, including entry, pivoting, persistence, and exit. We then develop propositions and discuss the model's implications for future competency research, training, and education. A key takeaway of our integrative model is that competencies acquired through experience and education are likely to enhance a prospective entrepreneur's self-efficacy, ambidexterity, human capital, and identity, all leading to greater entrepreneurial action.

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3. Compassion and passion: Exploring beneficiary wealth destruction in social entrepreneurship

Authors: Anne-Sophie Sabbatucci, Sophie Bacq, Frank Janssen

DOI: [10.1016/j.jbusvent.2026.106607](#) **Published:** 2026-09-01

Fields & Theories:

- **Fields:** Social Entrepreneurship, Business Ethics, Organizational Behavior
- **Theories:** Dualistic Model of Passion, Compassion (Conceptual Lens), Paradox Theory

Abstract:

Most research on social entrepreneurship the positive effect of compassion on creating wealth for beneficiaries. However, while compassion drives social entrepreneurs to take prosocial actions that benefit others, the actions it motivates can also be destructive due to the complex, interdependent nature of social issues. This paper explores the paradox of compassion in social entrepreneurship. We argue that compassion reduces the likelihood of destroying beneficiary wealth through two key mechanisms—fostering a more comprehensive understanding of beneficiary problems and triggering doubt about how social entrepreneurs are building beneficiary wealth. Yet, this relationship can be modified by the adverse effects of obsessive social entrepreneurial passion. We explore why social entrepreneurs are susceptible to developing obsessive passion and how it undermines the shielding effects of compassion, thereby increasing the risk of destroying beneficiary wealth. Our study contributes new insights by clarifying when and how compassion and passion may fail to safeguard beneficiaries, advancing theory on how social entrepreneurship relates to beneficiary wealth.

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4. Help or hindrance? Husbands' influence on women entrepreneurs' business success in Sub-Saharan Africa: A latent profile analysis

Authors: Kathrin Wolf, Mona Hafner, Jiarui Lily Zhou, Michael Frese

DOI: [10.1016/j.jbusvent.2026.106606](https://doi.org/10.1016/j.jbusvent.2026.106606) **Published:** 2026-09-01

Fields & Theories:

- **Fields:** Female Entrepreneurship, Developmental Entrepreneurship, Family Business
- **Theories:** Social Role Theory, Rational Resource Allocation Theory, Family Embeddedness Perspective

Abstract:

Husbands are often presumed to hold back women entrepreneurs in sub-Saharan Africa. In this study, we challenge this frequently voiced preconception and argue that some husbands provide resources to their wives' business development. Building on both social role theory and rational resource allocation theory, we consider the unique context of sub-Saharan Africa, suggesting husbands' influence consists of two dimensions: Husbands as constraints and husbands as resource providers for their wives' businesses. The two dimensions result in four profiles of husbands that are hypothesized to differentially predict women entrepreneurs' business success. Based on interviews with 192 husbands (one wave) and women entrepreneurs (two waves) in Ethiopia, latent profile analysis identified three out of the four postulated profiles: The Indifferents, the Copre neurs, and the Regulators. Husbands' gender role beliefs and their relative contribution to the family income differentiate between the profiles. Our findings indicate that husbands' resource provision improves women entrepreneurs' business success, even in the presence of constraining behavior. We conclude that husbands may make a difference in otherwise resource-poor environments, and they may deserve more attention toward a better understanding of successful women entrepreneurs.

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5. Skin lightening: The process of exploiting colorism-based opportunities

Authors: Dean A. Shepherd, Vinit Parida, Sarah Sarjoo, Joakim Wincent

DOI: [10.1016/j.jbusvent.2026.106618](https://doi.org/10.1016/j.jbusvent.2026.106618) **Published:** 2026-09-01

Fields & Theories:

- **Fields:** Entrepreneurship, Sociology of Entrepreneurship, Social Issues in Management
- **Theories:** Opportunity Exploitation, Social Identity Theory, Colorism (Conceptual Lens)

Abstract:

People with dark skin can be discriminated against, generating various adverse outcomes for them. Due to this colorism, entrepreneurs have exploited colorism-based opportunities—products and services that lighten skin color. Through an inductive qualitative study of skin-lightening businesses and their customers in cities across India, we move beyond supply and demand economics to theorize the psychological and social drivers that motivate people to treat the symptoms of this discrimination (yet, in doing so, reinforce this discrimination and exacerbate income inequality). Therefore, the study contributes to the entrepreneurship literature with new research on the process of exploiting colorism-based opportunities and their positive and (unintended) negative consequences.

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Volume 41, Issue 4 | Published 2026-07-01

1. Attitudes toward ambiguity among self-employed and incorporated entrepreneurs

Authors: Thomas Åstebro, Frank M. Fossen, Cédric Gutierrez

DOI: [10.1016/j.jbusvent.2026.106601](https://doi.org/10.1016/j.jbusvent.2026.106601) **Published:** 2026-07-01

Fields & Theories:

- **Fields:** Entrepreneurial Cognition, Behavioral Economics, Decision Sciences
- **Theories:** Ambiguity Theory, Subjective Expected Utility Theory, Decision Theory

Abstract:

How do entrepreneurs act on their beliefs when probabilities of outcomes are unknown but subjectively perceived? We theorize that two distinct dimensions of ambiguity attitudes influence entrepreneurial action: ambiguity aversion—the unwillingness to bear ambiguity—and ambiguity sensitivity—how individuals discriminate between different levels of perceived chances of success. The second dimension determines how much entrepreneurs adjust their actions based on new information—a distinct aspect that cannot be captured by ambiguity aversion alone. Our theory suggests that entrepreneurs with different growth orientations have different ambiguity attitudes as compared to employees. Using incentivized measures from a large-scale survey, we find that incorporated entrepreneurs exhibit lower ambiguity aversion than employees, indicating that they are more willing to act under ambiguity. Distinctively, unincorporated self-employed individuals show higher ambiguity sensitivity, indicating that their actions are more responsive to changes in their beliefs. These patterns persist after controlling for risk attitudes, optimism, cognitive ability, and demographics. Our results show the distinct impacts of ambiguity aversion and ambiguity sensitivity on entrepreneurial actions.

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2. Beyond “uncertainty”: How distinct types of perceived uncertainties catalyze or paralyze firm innovation

Authors: Renfei Gao, Stephen X. Zhang, Asghar Afshar Jahanshahi

DOI: [10.1016/j.jbusvent.2026.106605](https://doi.org/10.1016/j.jbusvent.2026.106605) **Published:** 2026-07-01

Fields & Theories:

- **Fields:** Entrepreneurial Action, Innovation Management, Strategic Management
- **Theories:** Perceived Environmental Uncertainty (PEU) Typology, Uncertainty Management Theory, Cognitive Perspective

Abstract:

Despite considerable scholarly attention to uncertainty management in entrepreneurship, it remains unclear how entrepreneurs' perceived environmental uncertainty shapes entrepreneurial actions, such as innovation actions, in their firms. A positive view interprets innovation as a promising approach to uncertainty management, thus suggesting a positive effect; while a negative view sees uncertainty as an obstacle to innovation, thereby proposing a negative effect. We reconcile this tension based on the typology of perceived environmental uncertainty (PEU)—i. e., state, effect, and response uncertainty, which respectively focus on the nature of environmental changes, the consequences of any changes for focal firms, and the availability or effectiveness of potential responses. We posit that state and effect uncertainty perceived by entrepreneurs encourages innovation actions, whereby the positive influence of state uncertainty is stronger than that of effect uncertainty. In contrast, we expect response uncertainty perceived by entrepreneurs to discourage innovation actions. Using hand-collected multiple-wave multiple-informant survey data on 146 small firms in Malaysia, we show evidence for most of our arguments. Our study disentangles the distinct impacts of three types of perceived uncertainty, thereby advancing a more fine-grained understanding of when perceived uncertainty catalyzes or paralyzes entrepreneurial action.

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3. Founders for hire? The role of venture studios in breaking the individual-opportunity nexus

Authors: Constanze Coelsch-Foisner, Laurens Vandeweghe, Bart Clarysse, Fiona Murray

DOI: [10.1016/j.jbusvent.2026.106600](https://doi.org/10.1016/j.jbusvent.2026.106600) **Published:** 2026-07-01

Fields & Theories:

- **Fields:** Entrepreneurship, Venture Creation, Organizational Theory

- **Theories:** Individual-Opportunity Nexus, Entrepreneurial Agency, Managerial Coordination Mechanisms

Abstract:

Entrepreneurship theory has often posited the founder as the central agent of venture creation; from identifying opportunities, to mobilizing resources, and driving execution. We examine how venture studios – organizations that systematically create new ventures by taking over traditionally founder-led processes – challenge this assumption. Drawing on an inductive multiple case study of 16 venture studios with 50 primary and secondary interviews, we reveal how venture studios develop and validate ideas independently from founders prior to recruiting them, and how they coordinate the entrepreneurial process when these functions are separated. Our findings contribute to the literature on the individual-opportunity nexus, the entrepreneurial process and open the research agenda on venture studios as a new phenomenon in entrepreneurship. Venture studios challenge the assumption that founder and idea are connected. We provide qualitative evidence from 16 venture studios using 50 interviews. Venture studios disentangle opportunity discovery from venture creation. They coordinate the entrepreneurial process through managerial mechanisms. Venture studios shift entrepreneurial agency from individual to the organization.

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4. Not me, not yet, not anymore: Founder identity and entrepreneurial disidentification

Authors: Aviel Cogan, Blake Mathias

DOI: [10.1016/j.jbusvent.2026.106584](https://doi.org/10.1016/j.jbusvent.2026.106584) **Published:** 2026-07-01

Fields & Theories:

- **Fields:** Entrepreneurship, Social Psychology, Social Entrepreneurship
- **Theories:** Identity Theory, Social Identity Theory, Role Identity Theory, Entrepreneurial Disidentification

Abstract:

Research recognizes that founders may struggle to identify as an entrepreneur. Yet, little is known about the process through which they may identify as not an entrepreneur. We bridge this gap by drawing on a longitudinal, qualitative study to develop the concept of entrepreneurial disidentification and clarify how and why it unfolds and evolves over time. Our findings reveal how entrepreneurial experience can disconfirm an identity as an entrepreneur through both social identity and role identity mechanisms. In doing so, we expand the explanatory reach of founder identity theory and extend its theorization of multiple identities and founder agency. We also advance understanding of identity tensions in the context of social entrepreneurship by problematizing the relationship between empathy and intersectionality.

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5. Stories under scrutiny: How entrepreneurs and investors negotiate entrepreneurial narratives in interactional exchanges during investment pitches

Authors: Jean S. Clarke, Nick Llewellyn

DOI: [10.1016/j.jbusvent.2026.106604](https://doi.org/10.1016/j.jbusvent.2026.106604) **Published:** 2026-07-01

Fields & Theories:

- **Fields:** Entrepreneurial Pitching, Narrative Theory, Interactional Analysis, Entrepreneurial Finance
- **Theories:** Social Constructionism, Narrative Theory, Interactional Sociolinguistics

Abstract:

Entrepreneurial pitching is normally framed as a unidirectional scripted performance, with entrepreneurs presenting pre-crafted narratives for investor evaluation. We reframe pitching as an interactional process in which stories are scrutinised, challenged, and negotiated through investor-entrepreneur exchanges. We apply sequential analysis to video recordings of the question-and-

answer sessions of 14 investment pitches in the UK. Our analysis identifies four recurrent interactional patterns: Unencumbered Storytelling, Resisting Presuppositions, Giving Ground, and Pushing Back. We also show how collective investor dynamics can further shape the trajectory of the pitch story. These findings demonstrate that investors are not passive evaluators but active participants whose individual interventions and collective questioning trajectories enable and constrain entrepreneurial storytelling. By foregrounding the interactional dynamics of pitching, we shift understanding of entrepreneurial storytelling, viewing it as a negotiated process rather than a scripted performance, and highlighting how the persuasiveness of entrepreneurial narratives depends on their capacity to accommodate investor challenges while preserving the integrity of the story.

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6. Unchained from land: Property rights reforms and farmers' entrepreneurship in an emerging economy

Authors: Xueru Yang, Xiaoke Shi, Kun Liu

DOI: [10.1016/j.jbusvent.2026.106602](https://doi.org/10.1016/j.jbusvent.2026.106602) **Published:** 2026-07-01

Fields & Theories:

- **Fields:** Institutional Entrepreneurship, Development Economics, Property Rights
- **Theories:** Institutional Theory, Property Rights Theory, New Institutional Economics

Abstract:

How do changes in property rights shape individual entrepreneurship in weak institutional settings? Although secure property rights are widely viewed as essential to entrepreneurial action, most research treats them as static arrangements rather than evolving institutions. As a result, we know little about how property rights reforms influence individuals' decisions to engage in entrepreneurship, or how these effects vary across social and institutional contexts. We address this gap by examining China's 2014–2018 agricultural land titling program, which formalized land use rights through a quasi-natural experiment. Using individual-level survey data and a staggered difference-in-differences design, we find that land titling increases farmers' likelihood of entering self-employment, especially among marginalized groups and in regions with stronger complementary institutions. These findings the dynamic nature of property rights, showing how institutional reforms allow individuals to reassess uncertainty and realign incentives in ways that motivate entrepreneurial action.

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7. Venture boards: Knowns and unknowns

Authors: Bart Clarysse, Johan Bruneel, Carina Lomberg, Timur Uman, Thomas J. Howard, Nicola Breugst

DOI: [10.1016/j.jbusvent.2026.106591](https://doi.org/10.1016/j.jbusvent.2026.106591) **Published:** 2026-07-01

Fields & Theories:

- **Fields:** Corporate Governance, Entrepreneurial Finance, Venture Capital
- **Theories:** Resource-Based View, Attention-Based View, Dynamic Capabilities

Abstract:

Venture boards shape how high-growth ventures learn, decide, and access resources under uncertainty. This special issue advances venture board research by shifting attention from boards as structure (composition and formal attributes) to boards as capability (routines and relational processes that channel attention, orchestrate advice and monitoring, and enable timely decisions). The eight articles collectively explore board composition, its changes over the venture life cycle, consequences on boards, and outcomes. Building on these contributions and the wider literature, this editorial advances five directions for future research: theorizing boards as capabilities and mechanisms, embracing epistemological and methodological pluralism,

unpacking micro-level decision dynamics, comparing venture boards with other sources of advice, and situating venture boards in their entrepreneurial ecosystems.

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Research Policy

Volume 55, Issue 8 | Published 2026-10-01

1. Action perspective on technological change: A triply-nested framework and case study

Authors: Zhixiao Hong, Jinghua Xiao

DOI: [10.1016/j.respol.2026.105545](https://doi.org/10.1016/j.respol.2026.105545) Published: 2026-10-01

Fields & Theories:

- **Fields:** Technology Management, Evolutionary Economics, Science and Technology Studies
- **Theories:** Process Theory, Institutional Theory, Socio-Technical Systems Theory

Abstract:

How do the actions of actors shape technological change? Prevailing cyclical models, which frame change as an alternation between radical and incremental innovation, struggle to explain three persistent anomalies: (1) non-substitutive competition between technologies, (2) asymmetric change between artifacts and consumer preferences or industrial categories, and (3) the co-existence of diverse actor strategies with macro-level regularities. To move beyond these limitations, this article develops an action perspective, conceptualizing technology simultaneously as information, function-in-context, and process—corresponding to the actions of interpreting, deploying, and configuring. Through a longitudinal case study of the autonomous driving industry (2004–2020), we develop a three-phase process model of legitimation, rationalization, and power. Our analysis reveals that technological competition operates across three distinct layers, leading to divergent outcomes: rapid displacement, long-term coexistence, or the creation of new markets. These layers exist in a recursive ends-means relationship, where change in an outer layer defines the purpose for change in an inner layer, but not vice versa. This asymmetry explains why artifacts can change without corresponding shifts in industries or preferences. In conclusion, while diverse actor strategies can lead to a multiplicity of outcomes and trajectories, the process of technological change is invariably shaped by the sequential and recursive constitution of information, function-in-context, and process.

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2. At cross purposes? Housing markets and innovation in American Political Economy

Authors: James D.G. Wood

DOI: [10.1016/j.respol.2026.105561](https://doi.org/10.1016/j.respol.2026.105561) Published: 2026-10-01

Fields & Theories:

- **Fields:** Comparative Political Economy, Innovation Studies, Macroeconomics
- **Theories:** Varieties of Capitalism (VoC), Growth Models Perspective, Institutional Theory

Abstract:

The Comparative Political Economy (CPE) literature offers two distinct but insufficiently integrated institutional accounts of US growth dynamics: the Varieties of Capitalism (VoC) approach, emphasising the economy's capacity for radical innovation, and

the CPE growth models perspective, which views the US economy as consumption-driven, supported by rising house prices and household debt. This paper argues that these two institutional complexes coexist within the US economy, generating conflicting pressures on innovation capacity that existing CPE frameworks have not adequately theorised. Specifically, the demand-side dynamics sustaining consumption-driven growth, supported by financial product innovations widening access to mortgage credit, may undermine the supply-side conditions underpinning innovation capacity, a cross-level tension that neither the VoC nor the CPE growth models perspective has incorporated. Using error correction models applied to an unbalanced panel of 50 US states from 1975 to 2016, the long-run results show that rising house prices are significant negative long-run predictors of innovation outputs, whilst expansionary state government fiscal expenditure can compensate for these negative effects. Furthermore, left-leaning state governments produce short-run innovation gains but long-run negative effects. Together, these findings suggest that understanding US growth dynamics requires moving beyond frameworks that treat the innovation-and-consumption-oriented institutional complexes as complementary, toward a more integrated account that incorporates the conflicting pressures they generate and the compensatory state government fiscal policies through which those pressures can be managed, with important implications for understanding the conditions underpinning US' growth and its international economic competitiveness.

[Open PDF](#)

3. Business model innovation for disruptive sustainability: A theorizing review on how interdependencies between business model components reshape the problem-solution nexus

Authors: Maria Schmidt, Aoife Brophy, Philipp Trotter

DOI: [10.1016/j.respol.2026.105533](https://doi.org/10.1016/j.respol.2026.105533) **Published:** 2026-10-01

Fields & Theories:

- **Fields:** Business Model Innovation, Sustainability Transitions, Strategic Management
- **Theories:** Socio-Technical Systems Theory, Disruptive Innovation

Abstract:

Global sustainability challenges demand large, rapid and systemic transformation of the systems that underpin modern life. Disruption is increasingly discussed as a trigger of these transformations, but the drivers of disruption have remained unclear. While much of the existing literature focuses on technological innovation as a potential driver, limited although growing attention has been paid to non-technological sources. This paper explores business model innovation as a non-technological driver of disruptive sustainability. We define disruptive sustainability as far-reaching changes in more than one dimension of socio-technical systems, triggered by a high-intensity effect, towards realising environmental, social and economic goals. We conduct a theorizing review of academic literature on the last mile in low-income and lower-middle income countries. We develop an explanatory model of how interdependencies between business model innovation components drive disruptive sustainability by re-defining the problem-solution nexus at different depths. Our contributions are threefold. First, we expand the conceptualization of disruptive sustainability by unpacking the crucial aspect of depth of change. We suggest that disruptions can trigger shallow, medium or deep change within and across dimensions of socio-technical systems. Second, we explain how the interdependencies between different business model innovation components drive disruptive sustainability by changing the problem-solution nexus at different depths. Third, based on these contributions, we develop a tool which guides stakeholders in driving disruptive sustainability in three distinct steps linked to different degrees of depth.

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4. Connectivity infrastructure and innovation: The effects of headquarters versus subsidiary management

Authors: Catherine Magelssen, Luis Ballesteros, Casidhe Troyer

DOI: [10.1016/j.respol.2026.105542](https://doi.org/10.1016/j.respol.2026.105542) **Published:** 2026-10-01

Fields & Theories:

- **Fields:** International Business, Innovation Management, Strategic Management

- **Theories:** Information Processing Theory, Organizational Structure, Headquarters-Subsidiary Relations

Abstract:

Improvements in connectivity infrastructure can stimulate innovation by reducing information frictions across locations, yet firms benefit unevenly, and the organizational sources of this heterogeneity remain insufficiently understood. Drawing on information processing theory, this study examines how the locus of managerial authority within multinational enterprises (MNEs)—specifically, whether R&D subsidiaries are managed by headquarters or by another subsidiary—influences the change in innovation from improved connectivity. We use a novel longitudinal dataset covering 1004 R&D subsidiaries from 78 MNEs and exploit the staggered global rollout of broadband as a quasi-exogenous shock to connectivity. Triple difference analyses using matched samples indicate that broadband increases subsidiary innovation on average, but the effects are driven by R&D subsidiaries managed by other subsidiaries. These subsidiaries experience substantially larger post-broadband increases in innovation productivity, knowledge flows from, and co-inventions with their managing entity than headquarters-managed subsidiaries. Additional analyses indicate that the gap widens when headquarters face greater information complexity, associated with larger MNE size, more extensive international operations, and broader roles, suggesting that headquarters' heavier information load constrains its ability to leverage improved connectivity. Consistent with information processing under constraints, we find suggestive evidence that headquarters prioritize their most important and technologically proximate subsidiaries. In contrast, subsidiary-managed units achieve innovation gains more broadly. Overall, the findings show that the innovation benefits of connectivity infrastructure hinge on organizational structure, highlighting the pivotal role of subsidiaries in managing innovation and the conditions that can impede or enhance these effects, advancing understanding of both connectivity-enabled innovation and MNE management.

[Open PDF](#)

5. Discontinuous but not disruptive: Lessons from green steel on sustainability innovation pathways for foundation industries

Authors: Viktor M. Salenius, Richard Cuthbertson, Jennifer Howard-Grenville

DOI: [10.1016/j.respol.2026.105541](https://doi.org/10.1016/j.respol.2026.105541) **Published:** 2026-10-01

Fields & Theories:

- **Fields:** Innovation Management, Sustainability Transitions, Industrial Policy
- **Theories:** Discontinuous Innovation, Creative Accumulation, Creative Destruction, Resource-Based View

Abstract:

The foundation industries that underpin modern economies are undergoing discontinuous transformations around sustainability and decarbonisation. However, key assumptions in the existing innovation literature are based on analyses of a narrow set of industry contexts largely focused on disruptive innovation. Alternative pathways to discontinuous change remain under-researched. This paper presents the first comparative case study of two of the world's most advanced green steel innovation ventures – Stegra and HYBRIT in northern Sweden. The two ventures were set up as, respectively, a start-up and an incumbent-driven joint venture, each with a different strategy for disrupting legacy steelmaking. However, neither followed a path predicted by the innovation literature. We find that the inherent resource constraints that are hallmarks of foundation industries led to a convergence of the two ventures' innovation pathways. We develop theory on discontinuous innovation for foundation industries and argue that system-level drivers, including policy triggers, material resource constraints, and non-material resource enablers shape firm-level innovation pathways. Regardless of their starting point as start-ups or incumbents, ventures in such settings converge on an innovation pathway of creative accumulation rather than creative destruction.

[Open PDF](#)

6. From expertise to action: STEM-related human capital in top management teams and corporate climate adaptation and resilience

Authors: David Bendig, Thomas Schäper, Katharina Hennes, Colin Schulz

DOI: [10.1016/j.respol.2026.105516](https://doi.org/10.1016/j.respol.2026.105516) Published: 2026-10-01

Fields & Theories:

- **Fields:** Strategic Management, Corporate Sustainability, Human Resource Management
- **Theories:** Attention-Based View, Upper Echelons Theory, Human Capital Theory

Abstract:

To safeguard long-term value creation and capture, incumbent firms face growing pressure to pursue corporate climate adaptation and resilience strategies. Given the pivotal role of top managers in driving adaptive change, this study examines how top management teams' human capital shapes firms' engagement in climate adaptation and resilience across different organizational and environmental contexts. Drawing on the attention-based view, we argue that science, technology, engineering, and mathematics (STEM) education directs managerial attention toward climate-related risks and opportunities, prioritizing climate adaptation and resilience responses over competing strategic concerns. We further theorize that this relationship is contingent on firms' inventiveness, their exposure to physical climate hazards, and climate change sentiment expressed by financial stakeholders. Depending on these contexts, STEM-educated top management team members are particularly valuable in processing climate-related information, developing corporate climate adaptation and resilience strategies that reconfigure existing business models and value chains, and mobilizing organizational support for their implementation. Analyzing data from the Carbon Disclosure Project from large, listed U.S. firms from 2013 to 2020, we find empirical support for our hypotheses. Additional analyses show that STEM education is more strongly associated with engagement in climate adaptation and resilience than other educational backgrounds and that its association varies across STEM subfields. Our findings advance understanding of how executive cognition and attention-directing contexts jointly shape firms' responses to climate-related challenges and the role of STEM expertise in enabling disruptive, sustainability-oriented transformation. We also derive implications for executive hiring, leadership development, and climate-related policy design.

[Open PDF](#)

7. Greening but concentrating? The unintended effects of China's voluntary participatory environmental regulations on firms' innovation portfolios

Authors: Dongyang Zhang, Dingchuan Bai, Yurun He, Rui Guo

DOI: [10.1016/j.respol.2026.105531](https://doi.org/10.1016/j.respol.2026.105531) Published: 2026-10-01

Fields & Theories:

- **Fields:** Innovation Management, Environmental Economics, Public Policy
- **Theories:** Knowledge Recombination, Crowding-out Effect, Porter Hypothesis

Abstract:

Voluntary participatory environmental regulations (VPERs) are characterized by firms' voluntary participation and incentive-based compliance mechanisms. Whether VPERs can effectively promote firms' green transformation remains a critical question for sustainability transitions. This study examines how China's Green Factory policy as a VPER, which encourage firms to engage in environmentally friendly practices voluntarily, thus preserving managerial autonomy and flexibility, reshape firms' innovation strategies and improve their environmental performance. Specifically, we use a double/debiased machine learning approach to investigate how the Green Factory policy affects firms' knowledge recombination activities, which are distinguished between high-novelty innovation creation and low-novelty innovation reuse. Our findings reveal that while Green Factory policy increases green knowledge recombination by 0.029 units for creation and 0.135 units for reuse on average, it simultaneously crowds out non-green knowledge recombination creation by 0.031 units. Further analysis identifies external constraints, external incentives, and internal investments as crucial mechanisms behind this process. Notably, we find that market competition and greenwashing mitigation emerge as effective channels for alleviating the crowding-out effects. Additionally, although proactively engaging in green knowledge recombination activities does not lead to prominent improvements in firms' overall productivity, it significantly enhances firms' green total factor productivity. These findings provide practical implications for policymakers and firms aiming to balance green incentives with maintaining broad innovation capabilities during sustainability transitions.

8. How knowledge diversity in research proposals affects the academic performance of funded social science scholars

Authors: Yang Ding, Fernando Moreira

DOI: [10.1016/j.respol.2026.105546](https://doi.org/10.1016/j.respol.2026.105546) **Published:** 2026-10-01

Fields & Theories:

- **Fields:** Economics of Science, Sociology of Science, Scientometrics
- **Theories:** Knowledge Recombination, Human Capital Theory, Absorptive Capacity

Abstract:

This study examines the impact of external and internal knowledge diversity in research grant proposals on academic performance in social sciences. External knowledge diversity is measured by calculating the semantic similarity between 10,482 social science research grant proposals from the National Science Foundation (NSF) between 1970 and 2019, and 74,056 proposals from 22 other disciplines, using SciBERT and cosine similarity. Internal knowledge diversity is determined by the variety of research categories derived from clustering within social science proposals. Additionally, we analyze 635,910 scientific publications of social science principal investigators (PIs). We investigate how the intellectual proximity between PIs' doctoral and postdoctoral publication abstracts and their proposals affects academic performance. Our findings reveal that increasing external or internal knowledge diversity in grant proposals is not significantly related to social science scholars' productivity or research impact. This lack of a statistically significant relationship suggests that while social science PIs may possess sufficient adaptive capacity to manage diverse knowledge portfolios without performance degradation, the anticipated 'diversity premium' did not materialize. In contrast, greater intellectual proximity between research proposals and PIs' early-career research during doctoral and postdoctoral stages significantly improves research impact. The impact of postdoctoral intellectual proximity scales with knowledge diversity, providing the essential expertise required for successful interdisciplinary integration and high-impact research.

9. Leaky mess or safety vaults? Team knowledge production and post-mobility knowledge spillover

Authors: Di Tong, Xiaoyu Zhang

DOI: [10.1016/j.respol.2026.105548](https://doi.org/10.1016/j.respol.2026.105548) **Published:** 2026-10-01

Fields & Theories:

- **Fields:** Innovation Management, Strategic Human Capital, Knowledge Management
- **Theories:** Knowledge-Based View, Knowledge Spillover Theory, Team Production Theory

Abstract:

Teams have become the primary unit for organizing knowledge production. While existing research has extensively investigated whether and how teams enhance knowledge production, it has paid scant attention to their role in safeguarding against knowledge spillover following inventor mobility. The literature presents conflicting arguments on this issue. Drawing on team innovation research, we contend that team production generates two types of knowledge: task-specific knowledge and metaknowledge. Task-specific knowledge is economically valuable and is fragmented among co-inventors, so that its risk of post-mobility knowledge spillover is lower when it is produced by larger teams. While metaknowledge is shared within the team and prone to mobility-induced spillover, it has limited value with the corresponding task-specific knowledge. Analyzing a sample of mobility events among industrial inventors using a within-event design, we find that knowledge produced by larger teams is more resistant to post-mobility spillover, being significantly less likely to be utilized by the destination firm. This protective effect is attenuated when co-inventors co-move and when the knowledge is inherently complex. Our study

contributes to the literature on team innovation and inventor mobility by underscoring the role of team production in knowledge protection in the context of inventor mobility.

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10. Patent pledging as collateral: Navigating the strategic dilemma from patents' private-market values

Authors: Yuandi Wang, Zi Li, Qianbin Dou, Jiashun Huang, Zhao Zhou, Toby Li

DOI: [10.1016/j.respol.2026.105538](https://doi.org/10.1016/j.respol.2026.105538) **Published:** 2026-10-01

Fields & Theories:

- **Fields:** Innovation Management, Corporate Finance, Intellectual Property Strategy
- **Theories:** Information Asymmetry, Signaling Theory

Abstract:

This study examines the strategic dilemma firms face when pledging patents as loan collateral, stemming from a disparity between the patents' private, firm-specific value and their public market value. We show how this value gap creates an information asymmetry for the borrowing firms in dealing with credit lenders, and propose that the borrowers address this challenge through a hierarchical collateral strategy: they pledge core-but-generalizable patents and reinforcing their value with credible signals - such as high external citations that indicate broad technological relevance - to convert private, firm-specific value into visible, lender-facing indicators of market potential, helping to close the information gap. Our framework shows how innovative firms navigate the trade-off in using patents as collateral by pledging those with high market value to ensure liquidity, while also ensuring high firm-specific value to signal credible commitment.

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11. Problematic persistence of innovation: Breakdowns and sociotechnical maintenance of the world's most enduring herbicide technology

Authors: Shane Hamilton, Beatrice D'Ippolito

DOI: [10.1016/j.respol.2026.105543](https://doi.org/10.1016/j.respol.2026.105543) **Published:** 2026-10-01

Fields & Theories:

- **Fields:** Innovation Studies, Science and Technology Studies (STS), Strategic Management
- **Theories:** Maintenance Theory, Sociotechnical Systems Theory, Technological Persistence, Value Creation and Capture

Abstract:

Innovation research tends to focus on emerging technologies, overlooking the processes that enable some mature technologies to remain in use longer than others. Existing explanations for why some technologies persist tend to emphasize either firm-level choices within a market-based selection environment, or institutionalized barriers to sociotechnical transitions. Neither perspective carefully considers how breakdowns in sociotechnical systems can initiate maintenance processes, repairing both material malfunctions and strained sociopolitical relationships. We draw on STS theories of maintenance to offer new insights into the longevity of technologies, particularly those that prove repeatedly problematic, illustrated in our focal case study of Monsanto's glyphosate herbicide. By conceptualizing maintenance as a mode of value creation and capture, we extend existing theories of technological persistence. We identify three mechanisms underpinning strategic maintenance processes and theorize on the temporal aspects of how those mechanisms operate across sociotechnical levels. Furthermore, we highlight the unequal distribution of agency for repair work, raising ethical and political questions about the social value of maintaining problematic technologies.

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12. The impact of digital startups' IPO events on complementary developers' contributions to open-source software communities

Authors: Jifeng Yang, Hao Jiao, Xiaoyu Yu

DOI: [10.1016/j.respol.2026.105544](https://doi.org/10.1016/j.respol.2026.105544) Published: 2026-10-01

Fields & Theories:

- **Fields:** Digital Entrepreneurship, Open Innovation, Platform Ecosystems
- **Theories:** Organizational Boundary Perspective, Signaling Theory, Governance Theory

Abstract:

Emerging technologies are transforming how entrepreneurs identify, pursue, and develop new business opportunities. Establishing open-source software (OSS) communities has become a key competitive strategy for digital startups. However, firm-led OSS communities face persistent tension between core appropriability and peripheral generativity, which makes contribution outcomes uncertain. Framing a startup's initial public offering (IPO) as a boundary-reconfiguring event, we use a linked GitHub and Crunchbase panel dataset (2008–2021) to examine how an IPO reshapes both the overall level of contributions and the internal–external composition and destinations of contributions in the firm-led OSS community. We also examine heterogeneity by conditioning on pre-IPO boundary baselines and compare governance formalization with IPO signaling to clarify the conditions and pathways through which IPOs reconfigure OSS contributions. Our study extends the organizational boundary perspective to the open-innovation context and illustrates the dialectical relationship between community leaders and complementors. It also offers advice to startups and maintainers on when to tighten core governance and when to widen peripheral interfaces so that commercialization does not erode ecosystem generativity.

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13. Utility model patent regimes around the world and over time: Strictness, usage, and economic development

Authors: Dan Prud'homme, Zitai Hu, Wenlong He, Curba Morris Lampert

DOI: [10.1016/j.respol.2026.105517](https://doi.org/10.1016/j.respol.2026.105517) Published: 2026-10-01

Fields & Theories:

- **Fields:** Intellectual Property Law and Economics, Innovation Policy, Economic Development
- **Theories:** Appropriability Theory, Institutional Theory

Abstract:

Utility model (UM) regimes offer faster and cheaper protection for incremental inventions than conventional patent regimes. However, despite their presence in many economies, we know little about how they vary or how those differences evolve and affect UM usage over time. This study examines these patterns across 75 economies from 1980 to 2020. We construct novel indices capturing UM regime “strictness”—the difficulty of obtaining UMs due to legal standards for novelty, inventiveness, and examination—distinct from UM regime “strength,” which reflects appropriability once rights are granted. We find that, regardless of UM regime strength, developing economies adopt less strict UM regimes, whereas developed economies impose stricter ones. This likely reflects greater concern in developed economies about limiting proliferation of IP rights for less technologically sophisticated inventions. Most importantly, UM regime strictness impacts UM usage. In developing economies, stricter regimes suppress filings, whereas in developed economies, filings follow an inverted U-shaped pattern, peaking at moderate levels of strictness. This suggests that UMs serve different functions across economic development stages: in developing economies, they support IPR learning and provide accessible, low-cost protection for less technologically sophisticated inventions; in developed economies, stricter regimes balance limiting the proliferation of such rights with preserving the accessibility and speed advantages that distinguish UMs from patents. Supplementary analyses show that UM filings are jointly impacted by interactions between UM strictness and patent regime strength. We discuss implications for policymakers designing UM regimes tailored to national contexts.

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14. Where do ideas go? A spatial analysis of the patenting impact of publicly funded basic science

Authors: Laura Toschi, Federico Munari, Maurizio Sobrero, Hérica Morais Righi, Sebastiano Leonelli

DOI: [10.1016/j.respol.2026.105528](https://doi.org/10.1016/j.respol.2026.105528) **Published:** 2026-10-01

Fields & Theories:

- **Fields:** Economics of Science, Geography of Innovation, Innovation Policy
- **Theories:** Knowledge Spillovers, Knowledge Diffusion

Abstract:

As societal challenges loom larger, discoveries are in greater demand, and evaluating the impact of publicly funded programs attracts increasing attention. We contribute to this debate by focusing on the spatial influence of scientific discoveries funded through grants targeting frontier research. Our dataset includes information on 6671 EU ERC-funded projects between 2007 and 2016, 172,683 scientific publications generated by these grants, and 34,513 patents citing such publications. Building on linkages between scientific papers and patents via non-patent literature citations, we use the project as the unit of analysis and employ a two-stage regression model to examine the probability that ERC-funded publications are cited by patents and how these citations diffuse across space and time. The analyses on our final sample of 4977 ERC-funded projects, generating 151,574 publications that are cited by 34,007 patents confirmed our hypothesis that higher quality research leads to a broader and faster geographical diffusion and partially confirm the hypotheses that diffusion paths and speed differ by applicants, although these differences do not always show the same patterns. Moreover, we also find that c) projects generating scientific output (publications) and technological outputs (patents) diffuse more broadly and faster; and d) projects led by more mobile and scientifically productive scientists diffuse more broadly and faster; We discuss these findings and show how they enhance and extend our understanding of the impact of science and its implications for policymakers and innovation scholars.

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1. Digital innovation as a bank risk mitigator: Empirical insights from Chinese commercial banks

Authors: Shengjing Yu, Xiaolan Zheng, Martin J. Liu

DOI: [10.2139/ssrn.5581051](https://doi.org/10.2139/ssrn.5581051) **Published:** 2026-09-01

Fields & Theories:

- **Fields:** Banking and Finance, Digital Innovation, Risk Management
- **Theories:** Information Asymmetry, Market Discipline Theory, Industrial Organization

Abstract:

The rapid spread of digital technologies has led traditional banks, long-standing pillars of the financial sector, to embrace digital innovation. This study investigates how digital innovation influences bank risk. We develop a new hand-collected index that captures five dimensions of digital innovation, namely volume, quality, agency, generativity, and convergence. Using a panel of 391 Chinese commercial banks from 2009 to 2018, we find that banks with higher levels of digital innovation tend to engage in less excessive risk-taking. This negative relationship is robust across multiple identification strategies, including difference-in-differences, instrumental variables, Heckman two-stage estimation, and change-on-change regressions, which address concerns of endogeneity. Two mechanisms explain this effect. First, digital innovation strengthens market discipline by improving bank transparency. Second, it enhances market power by improving loan quality and reducing information asymmetries between banks and borrowers. The bank stabilizing effect also varies across different dimensions and strategic goals of digital innovation. In addition, the risk-reducing effect is more pronounced for banks located in provinces with greater digital innovation by other

financial service providers, for non-state-owned banks, for banks lacking national geographic reach, and for those in provinces with stronger legal enforcement or more developed credit markets. These findings the strategic role of digital innovation in shaping bank risk and provide important implications for managers, regulators, and other stakeholders concerned with financial stability.

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2. Optimal financing design for drug development firms

Authors: Richard T. Thakor, Andrew W. Lo

DOI: [10.1016/j.respol.2026.105510](https://doi.org/10.1016/j.respol.2026.105510) **Published:** 2026-09-01

Fields & Theories:

- **Fields:** Entrepreneurial Finance, Innovation Management, Corporate Finance
- **Theories:** Mechanism Design, Agency Theory, Contract Theory

Abstract:

We examine optimal financing design for R&D-intensive firms developing new drugs. When firms raise external financing using equity, they underinvest in R&D. But when the set of contracts is augmented to include more general (non-linear) payoff schemes, options combined with equity financing, this underinvestment is reduced. We then use a mechanism design approach and show that such non-linear schemes can attenuate R&D underinvestment by using a novel financing design that combines equity with put options to provide bilateral insurance to firms and investors. Investors insure firms against R&D failure and firms insure investors against high R&D payoffs not being realized. Interviews with industry experts indicate both the attractiveness and feasibility of the new financing design.

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3. The coevolution of financial and technological innovations

Authors: Lin William Cong, Po-Hsuan Hsu, John P. Walsh

DOI: [10.1016/j.respol.2026.105495](https://doi.org/10.1016/j.respol.2026.105495) **Published:** 2026-09-01

Fields & Theories:

- **Fields:** Evolutionary Economics, Innovation Studies, Financial Economics
- **Theories:** Coevolutionary Theory, Institutional Economics, Systems of Innovation

Abstract:

Financial and technological innovations are central drivers of economic growth, yet they are typically studied in isolation. This article develops an integrated perspective on financial and technological innovation coevolution, emphasizing the bidirectional feedback between financial systems and technological progress. Drawing on historical evidence and modern developments, we show how technological advances reshape financial intermediation, while financial innovations—through capital allocation, risk sharing, and market design—actively influence the direction and pace of technological changes. We take a broad historical perspective and recurring mechanisms linking innovations in finance and technology, including complementarities in information processing, institutional dynamics, and feedback loops driven by data, platforms, and market structure. A key insight is that, in the current era, finance is no longer merely an enabler of technology but increasingly a driver of technological innovations itself. Moreover, we provide an overview of recent studies included in the special issue on “The Coevolution of Financial and Technological Innovations.” Finally, we discuss the challenges, opportunities, and policy implications for future research, as illustrated by these papers and for this interdisciplinary field in general.

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4. The rise of platforms in regulated industries: Ownership, curation, and the asymmetric strategies of challenger versus incumbent banks

Authors: Pinar Ozcan, Dize Dinçkol, Markos Zachariadis

DOI: [10.1016/j.respol.2026.105499](https://doi.org/10.1016/j.respol.2026.105499) Published: 2026-09-01

Fields & Theories:

- **Fields:** Strategic Management, Platform Economics, Financial Technology
- **Theories:** Platform Theory, Network Effects, Resource-based View

Abstract:

How do platforms emerge in regulated, data-sensitive industries? Drawing on 82 interviews and archival data on UK retail banking from 2016 to 2024, we show that challenger banks build platforms easily but struggle to grow their user base, as data sensitivity and partial outsourcing of resource-intensive infrastructure create a self-reinforcing cycle of trust, resilience, and resource strain. Incumbents face the opposite problem: established user bases offer a network-effect advantage, yet legacy IT, compliance siloes, and cannibalization fears constrain ownership and curation. We show how platform-as-a-service providers emerge in response, but powerful incumbent buyers reverse the platform power asymmetry by forcing closed curation. We develop a theoretical framework with implications for other data-sensitive sectors such as healthcare and insurance.

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Volume ?, Issue ? | Published Available online 29 May 2026

1. From pitch to progress: The interplay of team reputation and governance in crowdfunded innovation

Authors: Xin Deng, Yen Teik Lee, Qi Sun, Yu Yan

DOI: [10.2139/ssrn.5701723](https://doi.org/10.2139/ssrn.5701723) Published: Available online 29 May 2026

Fields & Theories:

- **Fields:** Entrepreneurial Finance, Innovation Management, Digital Entrepreneurship, Corporate Governance
- **Theories:** Signaling Theory, Agency Theory, Governance Theory

Abstract:

This study examines how team reputation affects both the funding success and the subsequent innovation progress in early-stage crowdfunded projects, with a comparative focus on blockchain-based and conventional crowdfunding platforms. Using development progress data for blockchain projects from the open-source platform GitHub, we find that while teams with stronger reputations raise more funds, their subsequent innovation productivity, measured by development activity, tends to lag. Further analysis reveals an association between higher team reputation and increased turnover of tokens post-fundraising, suggesting team members may strategically exercise exit options soon after securing financing. In contrast, analysis of Kickstarter campaigns reveals a more consistent alignment between team reputation, funding success, and project delivery. Specifically, highly reputable teams are more likely to meet not only their fundraising goal but also delivery commitments. We attribute this contrast to differences in platform governance; Kickstarter's structured oversight appears to mitigate early team disengagement and enhance project delivery compared to the blockchain context. These findings underscore the importance of effective governance mechanisms in crowdfunding platforms to ensure that team reputation signals translate into sustained innovation outcomes.

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